Faculty of Information Technology

FIT3161 Computer Science Project Part 1
FIT3163 Data Science Project Part 1
FIT3188 Cyber Security Project Part 1

Assessment details.

Project proposal report
Group submission.
V22092026

10%, Due Monday, 2 November 2026, 11:55 PM, Week 14

Learning Outcomes
This assignment targets all unit learning outcomes.

Introduction
Team members must contribute to a single, cohesive, well-structured and professionally formatted project proposal submission. Ensure the submission reads as one coherent document and not as a copy-paste of separate, poorly related sections created by team members working in isolation. To achieve this, it is suggested that the team:

- Agrees early on overall formatting, writing and diagram style and content arrangement.
- Plans how to allocate sections to be written / diagrams to be drawn by each contributor.
- Elects a member as overall document proof editor / style wrangler before submission.

Careful distribution of effort between all team members, and effective team communication, will be required to coordinate this submission.

Prepare your report from initial draft through to final version using an online edit-logged Google document that all students in your team can access. Please ensure that the edit log of this file can be made available to the teaching team to support your group member's claims of authorship.

Length of report

- The maximum report word count is 3500 words.
- Word count *exclude*s text in figures, data tables, cover sheet, references and appendices.
- **State your report's word count clearly on your submission cover page.**

Project proposal structure

Generic content in your assignment submission that can be applied to another project will likely score low marks. The content must show an explicit connection to **your** project, **your** experience, and **your** presentation.

1) **Front matter**
    a) Title sheet, table of contents
    b) Team member names
    c) Authorship Statement: (i) Against each project team member's initials, briefly, but explicitly, list the sections *of the report* for which they provided leadership by drafting the initial

version AND editing and finalising the contributions of other team members to ensure the section is ready for assessment. (ii) List all figures / diagrams / tables or other significant elements of the report produced or led by a team member where it is possible to assign leadership.

It is assumed that all team members contribute equally to the process of commenting and tweaking report contents; this does *not* need to be noted. But the named leader for each major component should be clearly stated in the way described by (i) and (ii) above. E.g. "Alan wrote the initial drafts and finalised the text for chapters 1, 3, 5. He prepared all materials for figures 1.0 – 1.6 and he prepared figures 3.1 - 3.5 using annotated screen-shots from the working software."

d) Total project report word count.

e) Other key elements may be added here at the discretion of a project team.

2) Introduction

a) Description of project aims and background.

b) An introduction and overview of the report and its contents.

3) Background material/literature review

a) Divide this section into clear subsections: an introduction to the literature review, the body of the literature review, and its conclusion.

b) In the literature review body and its subsections, identify, review and critique previous works (5-8 references) and software tools (any you can find) relevant to your project topic.

c) Synthesise your understanding of relevant published work, recent advances and their implications, by discussing common themes, ideas, techniques, outcomes and/or strengths and weaknesses.

d) Explain the rationale for your project (i.e., justify it) by reference to a need, gap or shortcomings you identify in the literature or existing software.

4) Project management plan

a) Project scope

i) Describe the product characteristics, functional and non-functional requirements (as refined) since the Pitch presentation.

ii) In an Appendix, include the full Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM) from the time of your Pitch presentation.

b) Project organisation

i) Specify the software development life cycle model to be used for this project – predictive / adaptive / incremental / agile and the rationale in choosing the specified approach and any necessary adaptations to your context.

Refer to the seminar slides/videos to understand process models and their applications.

c) Schedule and resource requirements

i) Provide an overview of the activities and tasks that must be completed to satisfy the project agreement. In an Appendix, include the detail of this as a Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) based on your earlier WBS.

ii) In an Appendix, provide a Gantt chart based on your earlier chart, accounting for task dependencies and required milestone dates that match the process model you adopt.

iii) Provide estimates of the total resources required to complete the project. Examples may include the number and roles of personnel required, computer time, software, hardware etc.

d) Management process

i) Describe the process to be used to identify, analyse, and manage risk factors associated with the project. In an Appendix, include a Risk Register of specific risks for this project. You may refer to the seminar slides / videos on creating a Risk Register.

ii) Monitoring and controlling mechanisms
- Monitoring of project progress against planned milestones. Specify tools that may be used (eg: Kanban board etc)
- Review and audit mechanisms. This may include maintaining records of meetings and other documentation and using version control software.

5) Methodology

a) Explain any specific algorithms (especially Comp. Sci. students), statistical analyses or machine learning approaches (especially Data Sci. students) you will use in your software. Provide an overview of each and high-level pseudocode if helpful.

b) Using text and an appropriate diagram (e.g. Architecture Diagram https://www.atlassian.com/work-management/project-management/architecture-diagram), explain how you will integrate your software/solution components.

c) Discuss the source from which data will be collected and explain how it will be pre-processed (required for Data Sci. projects, only if relevant for Comp. Sci. projects).

6) Conclusion

a) Provide a 1 or 2 paragraph summary of your report's key contents.

7) Appendices

a) Include the following documents (as noted above):

i) Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM)

ii) Risk Register

iii) Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

iv) Gantt Chart

b) Note: text in appendices does *not* count towards the document word limit.

8) Bibliography

a) Provide a complete list of references cited in the report. List *only* references cited in the report. Consider using reference management software, such as EndNote, BibTeX or Zotero to generate a correctly formatted reference list.

b) Provide full bibliographic details of references in APA format.

c) The reference list is not counted towards the document word limit.

d) Note: incorrect, muddled or incomplete references may be interpreted as evidence that Generative AI has been inappropriately used in the creation of your submission. Heavy grade penalties and/or disciplinary action may be the result of this - check your references! Any member of your team may be asked to provide them, and to explain during an interview what each one of the texts you cite contains.

Report Style and Presentation

Excellent written and diagrammatic communication skills are expected. The document should be formatted and presented at a professional level. All text sections, figures and diagrams should be clearly structured, labelled and numbered.

Marking

All team members are expected to make equitable contributions to this team task. However, marks are adjusted if the contributions of individual team members differ significantly.

IMPORTANT!
Failure to include the Authorship Statement in the front cover material will incur an automatic 50% penalty on the final mark for the assessment.

ALL team members must click the Moodle SUBMIT button. By clicking this, each team member approves the submission for grading, and agrees that the provided Authorship Statement is a true and accurate representation of the contributions of the team members.

Marking Guide

This assignment will be marked over 100 points but contributes 10% to the final unit marks. The maximum points allocated to each section is shown below:

1.	Front cover material	0
2.	Introduction	10
3.	Background material (literature review)	15
4.	Project management plan	50
	a. Scope and requirements (5)	
	b. Project Organisation (15)	
	c. Schedule and resource requirements (10)	
	d. Management process (20)	
5.	Proposed methodology	10
6.	Conclusion	5
7.	References	5
8.	Style and presentation	5
	Total	**100**

A detailed marking rubric is also available as a separate document on the submision link.

Additional Notes and Suggestions

Carefully plan your group's report production. Here are some tips.

1. Spend time carefully planning the write-up.
2. Consider carefully what material needs to be included.
3. Read this specification as a guide to what is likely to be relevant to your project and therefore what needs to be included, rather than as a set of "questions" you need to answer.
4. Discuss and document decisions amongst your team clearly.
5. The background section (literature review) should include material related to your project life cycle (predictive, agile etc.), technical consideration (software choices, tools) and research about the particular project area/topic. It should provide information to support any decision you make about your project.
6. In some sections you may find that text structured in point form is more effective than prose, but always write clearly regardless of the form of your text.
7. Share the task of writing the report based on the marks allocated to each section. Ideally, each team member will contribute approximately the same number of marks. However, the number of words contributed should also be considered.
8. Allocate workload for material such as the cover page, appendices, references, reviewing, proofreading and final formatting or style-wrangling.

Late Submission

1. Submission must be made by the due date. Late submission penalties will be deducted according to Monash University policy. (See Moodle, "Additional information and resources").
2. If you believe that your assignment will be delayed because of circumstances beyond your control such as illness, apply for an extension prior to the due date. Extensions and individual alterations to

the assessment regime will only be considered using the University Special Consideration Policy (See Special Consideration website, and follow the procedure).

Instructions for Written Group Submission if one or more group members are submitting late.

Group

- The group provides the document as requested by the original deadline.
- Work that was intended to be contributed (e.g. text or diagrams) by a student with special consideration is omitted.
- A placeholder must be inserted in the report in coloured text of the form, <TEXT/FIGURE SUBJECT TO SPECIAL CONSIDERATION - STUDENT NAME> at the location of missing contributions. Each student submitting late should be allocated a specific and distinct colour. E.g. orange, green, blue that is easy to read.
- A list of all late submitting students, their text label colour, and the page numbers of all inserted placeholders in the document for each student must be included at the start of the report.

Student with special consideration

- The student with special consideration must re-submit the entire written text (including the components submitted on time by the rest of their group) by their personal extended deadline.
- The student with special consideration must replace all previous placeholders, the work that they have contributed in their uniquely coloured (text).
- For newly included figures, outline them in orange.
- A list of all inserted text/diagrams and their page numbers in the document must be included at the start of the report.
- The Authorship Statement section should be updated to include the contribution of the student with special consideration.

Use of Generative AI tools in Projects and Assignments
See this assessment's Moodle module for the policy regarding use of GenAI in this unit.